

The oneAPI Specification

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November 2025



UXL built for multiple implementations

- Specification: A contract between the users and the implementers. Describes the architecture, design parameters, and requirements of compliant projects.
- Implementation: A given project that implements the specification.
- This two-step hierarchy works well for synchronizing collaboration across multiple implementations.

But, UXL only has one implementation

(and that is a good thing)

- Today, UXL does not encourage forking our projects into separate implementations. Each specification has only one implementation, our UXL GitHub projects.
- The implementations we encourage today are adding multiple HW backends. We encourage community collaboration directly on our UXL GitHub projects, on APIs, architecture, design, and backends (i.e., on everything the specification covers).

Recommendation: Move to a Dynamic specification

Option 1: (Not really an option) Keep publishing a quality, independent specification “release”	• Not really an option • Four of the components have not kept the specification up to date
Option 2: (Not ideal) Publish the independent specification release in its current state	• Has gaps • Unsure if anyone really cares, about the published spec or the gaps
Option 3: (Recommendation) Move to a dynamic specification. Pivot from publishing specification releases to maintaining a static specification page on the UXL website and direct traffic to UXL GitHub projects.	• No extra work. No gaps. • Encourages collaboration on UXL projects, not forking into separate implementations